

Postmortem: Duplicate Wire Records Caused False-Positive Alert Spike

Postmortem ID: PM-2026-0314 | Incident date 2026-03-14 | Severity: Sev-1 (upgraded from Sev-2) | Feed: WIRE_DAILY

Summary

The WIRE_DAILY Glue job failed mid-load. The on-call engineer reran the job without truncating the staging partition, which duplicated 18,412 wire records in the curated zone. Sentinel TM scored the duplicated data and generated 1,137 alerts against a typical daily volume of about 210.

Timeline (US Eastern)

Time	Event
03:52	WIRE_DAILY Glue job fails with OutOfMemory (month-end volume spike).
04:05	On-call engineer acknowledges PagerDuty alert.
04:20	Glue job rerun with larger workers; completes successfully at 04:58.
07:00	Sentinel TM scoring runs on curated data containing duplicates.
09:40	FCC Operations L1 analysts report an unusual volume of SCN-02 and SCN-03 alerts.
10:15	Incident upgraded to Sev-1; Priya Raman and Elena Brooks engaged.
13:30	Duplicates removed, Sentinel re-scored, false-positive alerts identified.

Impact

1,137 alerts generated; 927 were false positives caused by duplicate records. L1 analyst capacity was consumed for most of the business day. Time to detection was roughly 9 hours from the rerun.

Root Cause

The rerun wrote into a partially populated staging partition. NWB-RB-401 step 4 (truncate the business-date partition before rerun) was skipped, and step 7 (duplicate-key check) was not performed before releasing data to Sentinel.

Resolution

Duplicate rows were deleted from the curated table and Sentinel TM re-scored the day. The 927 false-positive alerts were closed administratively with BSA/AML Officer approval; the remaining 210 alerts followed normal triage.

Runbook Adherence

Not followed. Missing steps: **step 4** (truncate staging partition before rerun) and **step 7** (duplicate-key check). Steps 6 and 8 were performed.

Action Items

#	Action	Owner	Status
1	Automate partition truncation in the hdl-daily-ingest state machine before any rerun	Priya Raman	Done
2	Make the duplicate-key check a blocking gate before the Sentinel extract	Data Platform Eng	Done
3	Add alert-volume anomaly monitor (more than 2x baseline pages on-call)	FCC Risk Analytics	In progress